From policy to progress

reimagining agriculture in Uttar Pradesh



Agriculture has long been the backbone of Uttar Pradesh's economy, but in recent years, it has undergone a quiet yet consequential transformation. Under the leadership of Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, farming in the state is steadily moving beyond traditional practices towards a model that is natural farming, modern, market-linked, and materially rewarding. By integrating productivity with profitability, and technology with sustainability, the state has begun shaping a more comprehensive and resilient agricultural ecosystem.

Rise in Production

Despite possessing around 11 percent of India's cultivable land, Uttar Pradesh now contributes nearly 21 percent to the nation's foodgrain production—an achievement that reflects both scale and efficiency. Foodgrain output has risen from 557.46 lakh metric tonnes in 2016-17 to 737.40 lakh metric tonnes in 2024-25, marking an increase of nearly 32 percent. Oilseed production has witnessed an even sharper surge, recording an increase of about 193 percent over the same period—driven not merely by expanded acreage but by better seeds, improved techniques, and targeted government support. Looking ahead, the state has set ambitious targets of 753.55 lakh metric tonnes of foodgrains and 48.18 lakh metric tonnes of oilseeds for 2026-27—signalling sustained momentum. Efforts towards self-reliance in pulses have been reinforced through the "Mission for Atmanirbharta in Pulses" (2025-31), aimed at reducing import dependence. Large-scale distribution of seed mini-kits—3.97 lakh for pulses, 6.20 lakh for oilseeds, and 1.98 lakh for millets in 2025-26—has further lowered input costs while enhancing output potential.

